

Google Chrome

Google Chrome is one of the most ambitious projects by Google and there are very few people who can actually pick problems with it. It is an extremely fast and lightweight browser which packs a ton of features into its minimal interface. And what's more, this functionality can be extended even further by employing different Chrome extensions.

Multiple pages at start up

With Chrome, you can open up multiple pages simultaneously when you launch the browser. Simply go to the 'customize and control Google Chrome' button which is the right most

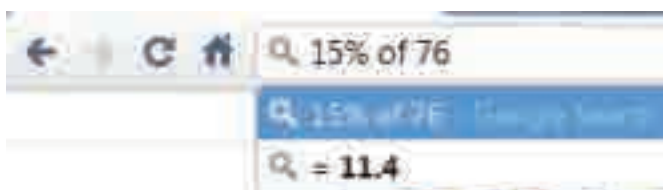


Explore more options under Google Chrome Options

button on the primary toolbar, and click on the options menu. On the first tab of the options window you can choose your homepage, simply click the add button to add all the individual URLs you want to open while Chrome starts up.

Calculator

Chrome's address bar is not just a simple address bar, but also doubles up as a calculator. Type in the expression, and Google will give you the answer.



Google's inbuilt Calculator in the address bar



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Incognito Mode

Chrome comes with a special secret mode that lets you surf the web anonymously. To activate this mode, click on the page control button, on the top right of the page. Just click on it and choose the 'New incognito window' or simply use [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [N] to open a new window in incognito mode. Any web site you visit while in this mode will not show up in your browsing history and all the cookies stored during this mode will be removed from

your system immediately after this tab is closed.

Navigation

You can right-click the back or the next navigation buttons to check the recent history. Additionally, you can simply drag and drop any of the tabs present onto your desktop to start a new browser window with only that tab open and in case you accidentally closed a tab or you want to open a recently closed tab, you can bring it back by simply pressing [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [T]. If there are multiple open tabs present in your browser window, you can cycle through them by pressing [Ctrl] + [1] to [Ctrl] + [9] on your keyboard.

Desktop shortcuts

Using Chrome you can create a desktop or start menu shortcut for any web site of your choice. Just open the site in Chrome and click the 'customize and control Google chrome' button on the right most corner of the screen. Then under the tools menu, select the 'create application shortcuts' option. You can choose to select any of the three

options, desktop shortcut, start menu shortcut and pinning it to the taskbar in Windows 7. Now from the desktop, you can just double-click the site to launch a new window with the site open.

Inspect memory usage

Right-click on any empty space on a web page and click on the 'inspect element' option to view the source code of the site in Chrome. While in the Developer Tools section simply click on the first line of HTML code, which will, in effect, select the entire site. Then click on the 'resources' tab and it will show you the usage of the memory by each individual element present on the web page. You can manually arrange the elements by time or size. With this window active, if you reload that particular page, all images and scripts present on the web page will show up on the graph and will be plotted in real time.

Firebug Lite Extension

Although Chrome has a very robust inbuilt Developer Tools section with similar features, seasoned web developers who are used to the magic of firebug in Firefox, with the help of the Firebug Lite extension can now use the same in Google Chrome. This is a great extension that helps with debugging and testing a web site in Chrome. The extension can also be used to see how certain cosmetic changes affect a site.

Web Developer Toolbar

The Web Developer toolbar extension for Firefox has been widely used by designers and front-end developers for a long time now. But fortunately, apart from Firefox, it is also available for use in Chrome but with a much better interface. The toolbar has many options for